

2025 Reading Review

I mentioned that I would include some commentary around a few books that I read throughout 2025. I'll select those that I enjoyed the most and discuss them briefly below. Hopefully you'll come across an interest and pursue one of them. Reading has always been my favorite hobby. I either got it from my mother or my paternal grandfather, both of which have inspired me to make reading a staple in my life. Most people workout below the neck, I'd urge you to not neglect the muscle above.

To provide some background, I'm one who reads multiple books at all times. I've learned this never gives you a chance to lose momentum. Reading is no different than working out or many other human activities in that it also benefits from the rule of compounding. The reality is that consistent reading compounds over time and you begin to experience an ease. Your lattice, *or spider web*, of knowledge is interwoven in a more connected fashion. Books read in isolation don't benefit you as much. I rarely read non-fiction and more times than not I try to keep a lineup of biographies, finance, history, and political topics in my rotation. I've found reading older books provides much more perspective than new issues. You'll notice this below in that some books are over three decades old, while the youngest are 2025 copyrights.

A Splendid Savage: The Restless Life of Frederick Burnham Douglas

- I have this book at the top for a reason. This work will inspire your imagination in many ways. The life Mr. Burnham lived is one that all great men will envy. From the American southwest, to the establishment of Rhodesia in South Africa, all the way to the gold rush in Alaska, Frederick represents the type of man who brought forth the greatest empire in history.

Empire of the Summer Moon: Quanah Parker, and the Rise and Fall of the Comanches, the Most Powerful Indian Tribe in American History

- This story will leave you fascinated due to its relative recency and geography. I've always been enamored when reading about periods that are thought to be long ago, but in comparison to human existence, are just a few moments behind our current reality. The story of the Comanches is one to engross yourself in.

The Technological Republic: Hard Power, Soft Beliefs, and the Future of the West

- This is a recent copyright and one I decided to read because of its author, Alexander Karp. He happens to be co-founder and CEO of PLTR. We've discussed PLTR for years now and if you haven't been living under a rock, you are aware of their recent success. I appreciated this book because after reading it you can truly understand the difference in politics running PLTR compared to other notorious big tech names. Overall, big tech is anti-American in every way they operate. That is not a controversial statement, it's a fact proven for over a decade now. Karp argues this and presents reasoning for why that is and how America should think about the future of her ever evolving role within a world filled with ever more powerful technologies.

The Nvidia Way: Jensen Huang and the Making of a Tech Giant

- This is a great example of why I read. You can't read this book and not go out and immediately buy Nvidia shares. A huge aim of my reading is to stumble upon investments. This book

illustrates how Jensen Huang operates and how Nvidia came to be the most successful company of all time. A fascinating occurrence of luck and determination that has created trillions in value. After reading this you will understand the vital role Nvidia plays in this world. What a blessing it is for Americans to have this company on the home team.

The Death of the West: How Dying Populations and Immigrant Invasions Imperil Our Country and Civilization

- This book was written by an individual, Pat Buchanan, who would have been one of America's greatest presidents. Reading this book today and knowing that it was published in 2001 will send chills down your spine. There is nothing emotional about the detail Pat lays out in his writing. I have immense respect for Mr. Buchanan. He's written several notable books worth reading.

George Jones: I Lived to Tell it All

- To preface, if you've never heard of George Jones you need to drop everything and go listen to his greatest hits album. *No Show Jones* is my favorite country singer of all time and commonly recognized as the "Rolls-Royce" of country music. A life filled with many highs and lows, Mr. Jones ultimately finished on top and cemented himself as the greatest country singer of all time. George Jones is your favorite country singer's favorite country singer. There will never be another.

Last Man Standing: The Ascent of Jamie Dimon and JPMorgan Chase

- Imagine you read this book in 2010, and after being impressed by Jamie Dimon's story, you went out and bought his bank stock. You're now shit rich because you bought JPM stock at less than \$30 per share. Anything and everything Jamie Dimon manages has been a tremendous success. He took JPM from the depths of the financial crisis into the #1 bank in world history and that continues into 2026.

Just Havin' Fun: Adventures of an Oil Well Firefighter

- Boots Hansen's life is one out of a movie. So much so, that a movie was based around his line of work and even starred the legendary John Wayne. The title of that movie is called *Hellfighters*. Boots traveled the world calming blown out oil wells that nobody else could resolve. From Texas, to the Arctic ocean, to the jungles of Asia, Boots was the go to guy.

Sonny Boy

- Possibly the most enjoyable book I read this past year. The autobiography of Al Pacino was a gift to me from my brother. Pacino's story from abject poverty to Hollywood is one everyone should read. You'll leave this title feeling like you just spoke directly to the legend himself.

The Singularity is Nearer: When We Merge with AI

- A book written by a tenured Google consultant and AI scientist, it is far above my reading level and one that challenged me with every page. I left this book feeling better about our future world involving technology. In our lifetime, we have the potential to realize alien level reality due to the advancements we are approaching. Few humans exist smarter than Ray Kurzweil.

Hess: The Last Oil Baron

- I've read dozens of books involving oil's history and none more entertaining than that of Leon Hess's story in building the Hess Oil empire. Not only that, but his family owned the New York Jets for many years. Funny enough, his son just sold the oil company for around \$55 billion to Chevron in 2025.

America Alone: The End of the World as We Know It

- Written in 2006, this author was cancelled after it was published and was targeted by leftists for years after. What you'll read in this book will describe our current reality in America to a T. I've urged many friends to read this with no avail. I highly recommend you read this.

Source Code: My Beginnings

- This is the first of Bill Gates' trilogy of books he is set to release. My father got this book for me and I was pleasantly surprised and found it tough to put down. I'm not a fan of Bill Gates personally and I'm one who thinks he has done tremendously evil shit around the world, but this book begins from his birth and into the creation of Microsoft. I think it is one of the rare pieces of work available that allows you to learn who Gates really is. Maybe the new Epstein files dump will bolster his book sales, we all know Bill could use the extra cash. I'll be reading the others once released.